

"Ridgeline HD 6.7 TD: Front clunk and uneven ride from worn front strut"

Document: tsb-22-350

Area: bulletins

1 Condition

Operators of the Ridgeline HD 6.7 TD may report a metallic clunk over bumps and an uneven or bouncy ride, particularly when loaded or towing. The noise is most evident on broken pavement and during low-speed turning maneuvers. Inspect the front strut assembly STRT-8500 for fluid leakage, a damaged mount, and excessive rod play. Confirm the symptom against the description in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Assembly before condemning components.

2 Cause

The clunk and ride degradation are caused by internal wear of the front strut STRT-8500, including a worn upper mount bearing and loss of damping force. High-mileage units operated under heavy GVWR loads experience accelerated seal and valving wear. This bulletin supersedes and complements prior diagnoses; if a worn lower control arm is also suspected, see Ridgeline HD: Front clunk and uneven tire wear from worn lower control arm , and for related knock symptoms refer to Ridgeline HD front strut knock from worn strut assembly . General system context is provided in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Suspension System Overview .

3 Repair Procedure

Replace the affected front strut assembly STRT-8500 in axle pairs following [PROC-STRUT] as documented in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Replacement Procedure . Support the lower control arm during disassembly and torque the strut-to-knuckle and upper mount fasteners to the values in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Sub-System Service chapter. After installation, perform a four-wheel alignment and road test to confirm the clunk and ride quality are corrected; consult the full Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual for fastener specifications.